| **Hard Balancing** | **Conflictive Hedging** | **Extensive Hedging** | **Cooperative Hedging** | **Bandwagoning** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Strong arms build-up and/ or external military alliance with the United States. | Stronger emphasis on confrontation over cooperation in India's China policy | Equal mix of cooperation and confrontation in India's China policy | Stronger emphasis on cooperation over confrontation in India's policy | India aligns with China. |
| | **Soft Balancing** India pursues limited arms build-up and informal ad-hoc security understandings among affected states short of formal alliances. It uses regional or international institutions, economic statecraft, and diplomatic arrangements to delay, frustrate, and undermine Chinese policies. | | | |

**Alignment Indicators**

| *Strong Alignment* | | *Moderate Alignment* | | *Weak Alignment* | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| India in formal military alliance with the United States. | US or other allied troops based in India on permanent or semi-permanent basis | Rotational allied troop deployments or limited access agreements. Participate in US-led operations. | Joint training, exercises or combat operations | India opens for arms sales / military aid from the US and allies | Statements of support for security policies of affected states (or criticism of China) |

**Military Indicators**

| | |
|---|---|
| Moving towards more confrontation: Sharp increase in defence expenditure, changes in defence posture or defence policies directed towards China indicate a move towards more confrontation. | Moving towards more cooperation: Reduction in defence expenditure, changes in defence posture or defence policies away from China indicate a move towards more cooperation. |

**Economic Indicators**

| | |
|---|---|
| Moving towards more confrontation: India enforces a more protectionist policy targeted at Chinese trade and investments, increases tariffs, imposes sanctions, and withdraws from projects. | Moving towards more cooperation: India's economic policy facilitates increased trade with China, and actively promotes Chinese investments in India, and Indian investments in China. |

**Diplomatic Indicators**

| | |
|---|---|
| Moving towards more confrontation: India cancels meetings, undermines Chinese initiatives, and opposes China in regional and/or multilateral institutions. | Moving towards more cooperation: India conducts an active bilateral and multilateral diplomacy with China, at high political as well as lower bureaucratic levels. |